

WHEN TO SELF-SERVE VS CONTACT HR (DEMO HK)

Document type: Operating guide for employees and People Ops

Purpose: Relieve HR of repetitive Tier-1 questions while protecting escalations that need humans

1. Self-serve first (use HR Knowledge Assistant / People Portal)

Use the assistant or FAQ when you need:

- Standard policy explanations (leave entitlement rules, hybrid pattern, expense thresholds)
- How-to steps in the company HR system (request leave, update address, submit expenses)
- Links to the right form or module name
- "What documents do I need?" for standard cases

Success looks like: employee completes the transaction or understands the rule without an HR ticket.

2. Contact HR / HRBP (open a ticket)

Situation | Why human

Exception to policy (extra leave, unpaid leave, remote abroad >5 days) | Discretion + risk

Payroll discrepancy / wrong pay | Sensitive + audit

Harassment, grievance, performance dispute | Confidential process

Medical long-term absence / disability accommodation | Case management

Immigration / employment letter / visa | Controlled documents

System says you lack permission after following how-to | Access / data fix

You disagree with a declined leave and need mediation | Judgment

3. How to open an HR ticket (demo process)

1. People Portal -HR Service Desk / Ask HR.
2. Choose category (Pay, Leave exception, Data correction, Other).
3. Describe the issue without pasting full HKID/bank numbers.
4. Attach screenshots with sensitive digits masked.
5. Submit; default SLA 2 business days for Tier-1, longer for complex cases.

4. What HR should not be asked first

- "How do I click request time off?" -how-to doc
- "How many AL days is the standard entitlement?" -leave policy
- "What's the hybrid default?" -hybrid policy
- "How do I change my phone number?" -personal info how-to

These are deflection targets for the employee assistant.

5. Metrics People Ops cares about

Metric | Intent

% Tier-1 deflected | Lower ticket volume on standard Qs

Citation rate | Answers grounded in policy pack

Escalation accuracy | Hard cases still reach humans fast

CSAT on self-serve | Employees trust the answers

6. AI assistant hard rules

1. Answer from policy + how-to with citations.
2. If the user needs an exception, pay fix, or sensitive case, tell them to open HR ticket and stop inventing approvals.
3. Never pretend to have submitted a workflow.
4. Never reveal other employees' data.
5. Prefer short step lists employees can follow in the HR system.